

Standard Chartered

3Q a bit mixed

Earnings Review

Key takeaways

- Weaker print this quarter reflecting lower Markets income, as guided earlier at our Financials Conference in September
- Partly offset by very good Wealth numbers, reflecting robust asset inflows
- The upgrade to FY guidance in terms of revenue growth and ROTE also positives. We think neutral for spreads this morning.

Sequentially weaker

This was a sequentially weaker set of numbers from Standard Chartered, as guided, and after a remarkable 2Q. Net income was €1.3bn, -25% on the prior quarter. Revenues came in lower as a result of lower trading income (as expected). On the positive side, though, we saw a very good performance from Wealth plus the bank upgraded its FY guidance. We see these results therefore as neutral for spreads this morning.

Markets down, Wealth up

Global Markets' revenues fell 28% qoq to \$848m as Macro Trading fell 29% to \$678m; Credit Trading was up 10% to \$206m. Wealth however had a very strong quarter, +20% to \$890m on Investment Product revenues +27%, with net new money of \$13bn., YTD growth of 15%. Given that costs are relatively inelastic, the cost-income ratio deteriorated to 61.4%. The bank upgraded its FY guidance to 13% ROTE and now expects to deliver income growth at the top of the 5-7% range. We are expecting Markets revenues to improve in 4Q.

Funding done

The bank reports the completion of its funding plan for this year and says it is now prefunding 2026, although forecast issuance volumes 'dependent on balance sheet momentum'. Next year, there are no AT1 calls, \$1.2bn of Tier 2 potentially redeemable and \$6.7bn of senior maturing. Risk-wise, we don't see anything of particular concern. The provisioning rate was 24bps in the quarter, although this is below the expected cycle range of 30-35bps. Some deterioration in the book noted owing to the downgrade of a sovereign. The CET1 as reported is 14.2%, with a share buyback ongoing.

30 October 2025

High Grade Credit
United Kingdom
Banks

Richard Thomas
Research Analyst
BofASE (France)
+33 1 8770 0291
richard2.thomas@bofa.com

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Valuation & risk

StanChart (STANLN)

High dependence on Markets income, in spite of positioning in some of the world's highest growth regions make us comparatively less enthusiastic on StanChart, together with its above-average exposure to tariff-hit Asian countries. We think bonds should trade quite wide when compared to UK peers. We are UW the \$5.005% '30 sr holdco. The \$4.644% is by no means expensive whereas the subs can seem tight to senior holdcos, in our view. The \$7.014% legacy T1s lack a Capital Disqualification Event clause which could allow early redemption but the bank considers they are the equivalent of Tier 2 for life, which is why it did not take the opportunity of low cash prices in 2023 to buy back these securities. Opco CDS levels look fair though we note the increase in opco issuance in the group which should have a bearing on levels.

We see downside risks from the uncertainty emanating from volatile markets income dependency, and exposures to emerging markets under pressure from volatile USD. China CRE, HK asset quality not out of the woods. Risk to the upside stems from less near term pressure than expected on the bank's core earnings.

Analyst Certification

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Security/Loan pricing

Standard Chartered / STANLN

Security	Amt	Maturity date	Ratings		Price	Price date	Yield (%)	Spread (Govt+bps)
			Moody's	S&P/Fitch				
Subordinated, EUR, Y5:CDS						30-Oct-2025		100
Senior Unsecured, EUR, Y5:CDS						30-Oct-2025		54
7.014, Tier1, USD, Perp/2049:B	750	30-DEC-2049	Ba1/BBB-	BBB-	106.03	29-Oct-2025	5.93	132
4.75, , USD, Perp/2049:B	1,250	31-DEC-2049	Ba1/BBB-	BBB-	94.18	29-Oct-2025	5.97	220
3.265, , USD, 2036:B	1,250	18-FEB-2036	Baa2/BBB-	BBB+	92.29	29-Oct-2025	4.94	119
SLA, EUR, Y5:CDS						03-Oct-2025		76
4.3, , USD, 2027:B	1,250	19-FEB-2027	Baa2/BBB-	BBB+	99.79	29-Oct-2025	4.46	78
7.75, , USD, Perp/2049:B	1,250	31-DEC-2049	Ba1/BBB-	BBB-	103.75	29-Oct-2025	5.52	186
4.644, , USD, 2031:B	2,000	01-APR-2031	A3/BBB+	A	100.68	29-Oct-2025	4.47	78
5.005, Senior, USD, 2030:B	1,500	15-OCT-2030	A3/BBB+	A	99.99	03-Oct-2025	5.01	122

For pricing information refer to "Other Important Disclosures" below.

B=Bond; L=Loan; CS=Capital Security (Not including Equity Preferred); CDS=Credit Default Swap; EP=Equity Preferred

Disclosures

Important Disclosures

Credit opinion history

Standard Chartered / STANLN

Security	Date ^{R1}	Action	Recommendation	Price
Subordinated, EUR, Y5:CDS	30-Sep-2024		Neutral	
Senior Unsecured, EUR, Y5:CDS	30-Sep-2024		Neutral	
7.014, Tier1, USD, Perp/2049:B	30-Sep-2024		Underweight	
4.75, , USD, Perp/2049:B	30-Sep-2024		Underweight	
3.265, , USD, 2036:B	30-Sep-2024		Underweight	
SLA, EUR, Y5:CDS	30-Sep-2024		Buy Protection	
4.3, , USD, 2027:B	30-Sep-2024		Underweight	
7.75, , USD, Perp/2049:B	30-Sep-2024		Underweight	
4.644, , USD, 2031:B	30-Sep-2024		Marketweight	
5.005, Senior, USD, 2030:B	11-Apr-2025	Initial	Underweight	98.22

Table reflects credit opinion history as of previous business day's close.^{R1} First date of recommendation within the last 36 months, if for an issuer or within the last 12 months, if for a security or loan. The investment opinion system is contained at the end of the report under the heading "BofA Global Research Credit Opinion Key."

Pricing information in the table is provided for each action where available. In the case of bonds, loans, capital securities and equity preferreds, the price shown reflects the nominal cash price for the security; and in the case of CDS, the price shown reflects the spread, on the date of the relevant action.

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Neutral: No purchase or sale of CDS is recommended.

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Coverage Universe	Count	Percent	Inv. Banking Relationships ^{R2}	Count	Percent
Buy	135	38.90%	Buy	109	80.74%
Hold	158	45.53%	Hold	132	83.54%
Sell	54	15.56%	Sell	48	88.89%

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